

Name: _____

____ out of 25

Grab the reader's attention	1 No attention grabber included. Starts with text immediately.	2 Attention grabber attempted but feels out of place/lacks connection to text.	3 Strong attention grabber that flows into writing.
Use of Detail	1 Is fact heavy with little to no descriptions of facts and their importance.	2 Facts are presented with vague explanations and descriptions added.	3 Facts are presented with further explanations and descriptions added.
Organization	1 Lacks paragraph organization (related information is not grouped into paragraphs)	2 Some information is presented in organized paragraphs (attempted to group related information)	3 Paragraphs are clearly organized and on topic (related information is grouped)
Smooth Transition/ Flow	1 Uses little to no linking words and phrases (e.g., also, another, and, more, but) to connect ideas within categories of information (list of facts)	2 Uses some linking words and phrases (e.g., also, another, and, more, but) to connect ideas within categories of information	3 Use linking words and phrases (e.g., also, another, and, more, but) to connect ideas within categories of information
Accurate Information	1 Student includes some opinions or information not backed up by research	2 Student includes information that is factual and research based	
Spelling	1 Spelling impacts the understanding of the story	2 Spells majority of grade level words correctly as well as domain specific words	3 Spells all grade level words correctly as well as domain specific words
Punctuation	1 Student uses little to no punctuation	2 Student has some punctuation errors	3 Student has minimal punctuation errors
Sites Sources	1 Student sites only one source or unreliable sources	2 Student sites reliable sources where information was found	
Closure	1 Story ends abruptly	2 Story has somewhat of a closure	3 Story has a solid sense of closure



Asterina Minata

By Example Author

Have you ever heard of an Asterina Miniata? Chances are you have and you just aren't aware of it yet. That's why I'm here! In this essay you will learn all about my favorite animal, the Asterina Minata. This creature is orange, tan, yellow and sometimes even blue. These vibrant colors cover it's hard, spiny, star-shaped body. Just like a star, this animal mostly has 5 points/arms but can sometimes have up to 50 arms. These arms are not quite like our arms, these arms are covered with suckers on their under side. These tube-like parts work as suction cups to help keep the animal from washing away with the tide. This creatures arms also help the animal see. At the end of each arm they have an eyeball... I know creepy right. They're always watching, but no need to be too afraid, these animals are only .2 to 11 pounds.

If you haven't guessed it yet, this fascinating creature is also known as the sea star or starfish. The starfish does not live in outer-space and shine in the night sky but instead is found shining among the ocean waves. You can actually find a sea star in any ocean across the world. These creatures mainly stay in shallow water but can live as deep as 6,000 feet. Many starfish make their home under the sand, in kelp beds or coral reefs. They are not in need of a big home because sea stars are very independent and spend most of their lives alone. Sounds a little lonely right, but every now and then they will gather with their friends to eat.

You now know all about the Asterina Minata. We have learned about it's physical description, region, behavior, basic needs and interesting facts. This is a fascinating creature that has developed many adaptations for survival. If you would like to learn more information about the sea star you can visit National Geographic Kids, Pebble Go, Wonderopolis, San Diego Zoo Kids or your public library!

